

Daniela Napoli

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Highlight Summary

- User researcher with a PhD in HCI and nearly a decade of mixed-methods research experience across industry UX and academic HCI.
- Pairs qualitative depth (discovery, contextual inquiry, journey mapping) with rigorous quantitative benchmarking (SUS, SUPR-Q, inferential statistics).
- Most recently served as embedded researcher on CIHI's highest-priority program; 12+ studies delivered across two senior-role tenures inform design, feature prioritization, and technical requirements.
- Domain experience in healthcare data, enterprise software, aviation training, accessibility, usable privacy.

Research Methods & Tools

- **Qualitative methods:** Semi-structured interviews, contextual inquiry, journey mapping, concept testing, heuristic evaluations, think-aloud usability testing, affinity mapping, severity ranking, thematic analysis.
- **Quantitative methods:** Unmoderated task-based testing, validated questionnaires (SUS, SUPR-Q, UX-Lite, NPS), descriptive & inferential statistics (t-tests, ANOVA, chi-square).
- **Research platforms:** Optimal Workshop, Loop11, Questback.
- **Surveys:** Qualtrics, SurveyMonkey, Google Forms, Microsoft Forms.
- **Analysis:** Python, R, SPSS, NVivo, Excel.
- **Collaboration:** Mural, Miro, Confluence, Figma.
- **Analytics:** Hotjar, GA4.

User Research Experience

Senior User Experience Researcher

Oct 2025 – Current

Canadian Institute for Health Information, Toronto, Ontario

- Lead 3 generative discovery studies (20+ user interviews, Canada-wide survey, concept testing) to guide modernization of legacy products serving clients across all 13 Canadian provinces and territories.
- Conducted several studies within a longitudinal findability benchmarking program (2021–2026); the 2026 study quantified a 20% overall lift in task success and a 395%

improvement on methodology-finding tasks in a redesigned product vs. its legacy version.

- Serve as embedded researcher on CIHI's highest-priority program across two senior-role tenures; 12+ studies delivered to date.
- Insights have directly informed design decisions, feature prioritization processes, and technical requirements definitions for the program.
- Mentor a junior researcher on study design, analysis, research strategy, and collaborator communication.

Senior User Experience Researcher

Oct 2021 – Mar 2023

Canadian Institute for Health Information, Toronto, Ontario

- Designed and ran early studies in a longitudinal findability benchmarking program for a flagship KPI report, establishing the baseline and methodology that anchored multi-year measurement.
- Led requirements discovery shaping the program's initial target model (future vision and modernization strategy): 15 user interviews and 10 collaborator interviews.
- Recommendations were implemented in the retirement of legacy offerings and the release of new products designed around the user needs surfaced in discovery.

💡 Read more: [Requirements Discovery](#).

User Experience Researcher, Intern

Sep 2020 – Dec 2020

Canadian Institute for Health Information, Ottawa, Ontario

- Facilitated 2–3 cross-departmental workshops focused on refining user personas.
- Contributed to ~10 user interviews to validate and develop user personas.
- Developed Python modules to automate persona mapping from research findings and website metadata — replaced a manual process that previously took the team a week or more per cycle; became part of the team's ongoing persona refresh workflow.

💡 Read more: [Persona Automation](#)

Design Researcher, Intern

May 2019 – Dec 2019

IBM, Ottawa, Ontario

- Conducted and analyzed ~15 user interviews across Design, Development, and Product Management to map workflows, identify organizational pain points, and uncover collaboration opportunities.
- Designed and facilitated a cross-department design-thinking workshop (~20 participants) using as-is scenario mapping, value proposition analysis, and need-

statement techniques to ideate solutions for workflow challenges.

- Packaged and presented key findings to internal collaborators and at an internship-related conference.



Read more: [Improving Interdisciplinary Workflows](#)

Human Factors Consultant, Intern

Jan 2017 – Jul 2017

CAE, Ottawa, Ontario

- Collaborated with developers on a proof-of-concept for a cost-effective virtual-reality aviation training system; conducted usability studies (n=10) assessing impact on users' learning goals and situational awareness.
- Co-designed and co-facilitated a director-level workshop using emergency-scenario simulations; captured findings and synthesized them into a recommendations report informing formal organizational response plans.
- Systematically reviewed academic literature on AR in military training to support an R&D proposal.

Education

Doctor of Philosophy in Computer Science

Sep 2018 – Aug 2025

Carleton University, Ottawa, Ontario

- Thesis: [Tailoring Remote Healthcare Technology to Meet the Needs and Privacy Expectations of Older Adults](#)
- Senior member of Carleton's Human Oriented Research in Usable Security [\(CHORUS\)](#) lab

Master of Arts in Human-Computer Interaction

Sep 2016 – May 2018

Carleton University, Ottawa, Ontario

- Thesis: [Accessible and Usable Security: Exploring Visually Impaired Users' Online Security and Privacy Strategies](#)
- Junior member of Carleton's Human Oriented Research in Usable Security [\(CHORUS\)](#) lab

Selected Publications

- Napoli, D., et al. ["I'm Literally Just Hoping This Will Work": Obstacles Blocking the Online Security and Privacy of Users with Visual Disabilities](#). *Symposium on Usable Privacy and Security (SOUPS)*, 2021 — 35 citations.

- Napoli, D., et al. [Developing Accessible and Usable Security \(ACCUS\) Heuristics](#). *ACM CHI Extended Abstracts*, 2018 — 24 citations.
- Napoli, D., et al. [Exploring User Perspectives on Data Collection, Data Sharing Preferences, and Privacy Concerns with Remote Healthcare Technology](#). *HCI International (HCII)*, 2025 — large-scale survey, n=384.
- Napoli, D., et al. [Helpful but Terrifying: Older Adults' Perspectives of AI in Remote Healthcare Technology](#). *HCI International (HCII)*, 2025.

Selected Invited Talks

- Considering Privacy & AI in Remote Healthcare Technology for Older Adults — *Wisdom Exchange Project*, Dec 2025.
- The U in UX Can Be For Everyone: Accessible and Usable Privacy — *uXperience Think Privacy Design Jam*, University of Waterloo (workshop facilitator).
- Design Tips to Help Non-Visual Visitors Stay Secure Online — *10th Annual Accessibility Conference*, University of Guelph.

Professional Development

AI Fluency: Framework & Foundations	Course	June 2026
Anthropic Academy		
The Complete Games User Research Fundamentals	Course	Mar 2026 – Current
Games User Research with Steve Bromley		
Nielsen Norman Group Certified	Courses	Aug 2022
Nielsen Norman Group		
• Statistics for UX • Measuring UX & ROI • Discovery: Building the Right Thing		
Workshop Organizer	Leadership	Aug 2021
17th Annual Symposium on Usable Privacy and Security (SOUPS)		
Mentoring Program Co-Chair	Leadership	Aug 2020
16th Annual Symposium on Usable Privacy and Security (SOUPS)		
Enterprise Design Thinking Co-Creator	Certificate	Dec 2019
IBM, Ottawa, Ontario		
• Learn more about the Co-Creator skillset and badge criteria.		